KEY TOPIC 2: CHALLENGES TO ELIZABETH AT HOME AND ABROAD, 1569–88

Paper 2: Early Elizabethan England, 1558–88



COURSE TEXTBOOK

Contents

Lesson 1: KT2.1: Plots and revolts at home

Lesson 2: KT2.2: Relations with Spain

Lesson 3: KT2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88

Lesson 4: KT2.4: The Armada

L1: KT2.1: Plots and revolts at home

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- [ ] Understand the reasons for, and the significance of, the Revolt of the Northern Earls (1569–70).
- [ ] Analyse the key features and significance of the Ridolfi, Throckmorton, and Babington plots.
- [ ] Evaluate the methods used by Sir Francis Walsingham and his use of spies to uncover treason.
- [ ] Explain the reasons for, and the immense geopolitical significance of, Mary, Queen of Scots' execution in 1587.

Recall & Retrieval

1. Why did Mary, Queen of Scots flee to England in 1568?

2. What was Elizabeth's immediate reaction to Mary's arrival?

3. Why was Mary, Queen of Scots a massive threat to Elizabeth?

4. What was the Casket Letters affair?

5. What was the Papal Bull of 1570?

6. What was the 'Crucifix Controversy'?

7. What were the Royal Injunctions?

8. How much debt did Elizabeth inherit?

9. What was the 'Auld Alliance'?

10. What did William Harvey discover?

Vocabulary Check

The Odd One Out: *Circle ONE term that does not belong with the others. Explain your reasoning: What historical connection links the other terms, and why is your chosen term different?*

Revolt of the Northern Earls | Ridolfi Plot | Throckmorton Plot | Babington Plot | Walsingham's Spy Network | Bond of Association

Teacher Model / Pupil Reasoning:

Source S1: The Northern Earls



An illustration of the rebellion of the Northern Earls in 1569.

The arrival of Mary, Queen of Scots in England in 1568 provided disgruntled English Catholics with a figurehead. This tension exploded a year later when the Earl of Northumberland (Thomas Percy) and the Earl of Westmorland (Charles Neville) led a major military uprising. Their motives were heavily mixed. Religiously, they resented Elizabeth's settlement and the appointment of the radical Protestant James Pilkington as Bishop of Durham. Politically, the earls were furious at losing their traditional northern influence to Protestant 'new men' like William Cecil, John Forster, and Robert Dudley. The rebels successfully captured Durham Cathedral, celebrating a traditional Catholic Mass. Their goal was to depose Elizabeth, marry Mary to the Duke of Norfolk, and restore Catholicism. However, the revolt failed miserably. Its defeat was a *catalyst for* brutal government reprisals; Elizabeth executed 450 rebels to set a terrifying example.

Q1. What combination of religious loyalty and political grievance motivated the Northern Earls to rebel in 1569?

Following the 1570 Papal Bull excommunicating Elizabeth, the government began to monitor Catholics much more severely. In **1581**, strict new laws were passed: families could be heavily fined for sheltering secret priests, and it became high treason to convert anyone to Catholicism. Against this tense backdrop, subsequent plots were able to attract widespread Catholic support at home and abroad. * **The Ridolfi Plot (1571):** Organised by Roberto Ridolfi, an Italian banker and Papal spy. The plan involved murdering Elizabeth and launching a massive Spanish invasion from the Netherlands using 10,000 troops led by The Duke of Alba. William Cecil uncovered the plot, which led directly to the execution of the Duke of Norfolk in 1572. ***The Throckmorton Plot (1583):*** *This plot planned for the French Duke of Guise to invade England, funded by Philip II of Spain and the Pope. Francis Throckmorton acted as the vital go-between for Mary, Queen of Scots. Walsingham's spies discovered papers at Throckmorton's house containing a list of Catholic sympathisers, proving the terrifying reality of the "enemy within". Throckmorton was tortured and executed in 1584, and the plot* exacerbated* government paranoia, leading to the Bond of Association and the expulsion of the Spanish Ambassador, Mendoza.

Q2. How did the 1570 Papal Bull transform the English government's treatment of Catholic recusants during the 1570s and 1580s?

Elizabeth survived these relentless threats largely due to her 'Spymaster', Sir Francis Walsingham. He built a formidable intelligence network, employing paid informants in every major town and spies abroad in France, Spain, and Italy. Walsingham routinely used ciphers for correspondence and hired expert code-breakers, like Thomas Phelippes, to decipher enemy messages. He also utilised **agents provocateurs**, such as Gilbert Gifford, who actively encouraged plotters to communicate with Mary so they could be trapped. This system triumphed during the **Babington Plot (1586)**. Anthony Babington wrote directly to Mary detailing a plot to murder Elizabeth and invade with The Duke of Guise. Walsingham intercepted the letters, finding irrefutable evidence of Mary's direct approval of the assassination. Babington was hanged, drawn, and quartered.

Q3. Vocabulary in Context: What techniques did Sir Francis Walsingham use as Elizabeth's 'Spymaster' to dismantle Catholic plots?

With Mary's written involvement exposed, she was tried and convicted under the highly specific **Act for the Preservation of the Queen's Safety**. Mary remained a severe threat as long as she lived, and her execution was *intrinsically linked* to the very real threat of a Spanish invasion. Despite delaying for months, Elizabeth finally signed the death warrant, and Mary was beheaded at Fotheringhay Castle in February 1587.

Q4. Causal Linkage: How did Walsingham's handling of the 1586 Babington Plot directly seal Mary Stuart's execution?

Between 1569 and 1586, the Catholic threat against Elizabeth fundamentally evolved. It began as a domestic dispute regarding northern noble power and traditional faith (The Northern Earls). However, the Ridolfi, Throckmorton, and Babington plots demonstrated a lethal intersection of English Catholic plotting and direct foreign (Spanish and French) military backing, forcing the government to pass harsh anti-Catholic laws in 1581. Elizabeth's survival was almost entirely reliant on Sir Francis Walsingham's sophisticated intelligence network. Ultimately, Mary's execution in 1587 brutally eradicated the domestic threat of a Catholic replacement, but in doing so, it became the definitive trigger for the launch of the Spanish Armada.

Q5. Constrained Summary: Summarise how Catholic conspiracies changed between the Ridolfi Plot (1571) and the Babington Plot (1586) in two points.

Pair & Share Activity

Q6. Discuss with your partner: Which plot posed the greatest danger to Elizabeth's life?

L2: KT2.2: Relations with Spain

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- [ ] Understand the complex roots of the Anglo-Spanish conflict, focusing on religious, political, and commercial rivalry.
- [ ] Explain the significance of English involvement in the Netherlands, specifically the 1585 Treaty of Nonsuch.
- [ ] Analyse the causes and Philip II's strategic plan for the Spanish Armada.
- [ ] Evaluate the reasons for the Armada's catastrophic failure, weighing English tactics against Spanish mistakes and the weather.

Recall & Retrieval

1. What was the Revolt of the Northern Earls (1569)?

2. What was the Ridolfi Plot (1571)?

3. What was the Throckmorton Plot (1583)?

4. What was the Babington Plot (1586)?

5. Who was Francis Walsingham?

6. Why did Mary, Queen of Scots flee to England in 1568?

7. What was the Casket Letters affair?

8. Who was the Pope that excommunicated Elizabeth in 1570?

9. What was the Act of Uniformity?

10. Who published the Germ Theory?

Vocabulary Check

The Golden Sentence: *Choose TWO terms from the word bank. Write ONE grammatically sophisticated, historically accurate sentence connecting them using a causal conjunction (because, although, or consequently):*

Privateer | Circumnavigation | New World | San Juan de Ulúa | Drake's Raid on Cadiz | Singeing the King of Spain's Beard

Teacher Model / Pupil Sentence:

Source S1: Philip II of Spain



A portrait of King Philip II of Spain, the most powerful monarch in Europe at the time.

By the 1580s, relations between England and Spain had severely deteriorated. At the heart of this was religion. King Philip II of Spain was a devout, fanatical Catholic who saw it as his holy duty to destroy Protestantism across Europe. Tensions were deeply fuelled by Philip II's desire to return England to Catholicism. He had already backed the Ridolfi, Throckmorton, and Babington plots to overthrow Elizabeth.

However, money was equally important. Spain controlled the incredibly lucrative New World (the Americas) and strictly forbade other nations from trading there. In response, Elizabeth secretly hired **privateers**, such as Sir Francis Drake and John Hawkins, to raid Spanish ports and steal from their treasure fleets. During his circumnavigation of the globe (1577–80), Drake captured roughly £400,000 worth of Spanish silver. When Elizabeth publicly knighted Drake upon his return, Philip was furious, viewing it as Elizabeth openly celebrating a common thief.

Q1. Identify the three fundamental causes of long-term conflict between Elizabethan England and Philip II's Spanish Empire.

The proxy war turned into an open conflict over the Netherlands. The Netherlands was ruled by Spain, but the Dutch Protestants had rebelled against harsh Spanish Catholic rule. Philip sent the brutal Duke of Alba with an army to crush them. Elizabeth knew that if Spain fully secured the Netherlands, the Spanish army would be just miles from the English coast, ready to invade.

Therefore, in 1585, Elizabeth crossed the point of no return. She signed the **Treaty of Nonsuch**, officially pledging military support to the Dutch rebels. She sent the Earl of Leicester with 7,400 English troops to fight the Spanish. By directly fighting Philip's army in the Netherlands, England and Spain were now practically at open war.

Q2. Why was Spanish control of the Netherlands considered an existential national security threat by Elizabeth's Privy Council?

The final trigger for the Spanish Armada was the execution of Mary, Queen of Scots, in 1587. With Mary dead, there was no longer a Catholic heir to the English throne. Philip II realised that assassination plots were useless; if he wanted a Catholic England, he would have to conquer it himself.

To delay Philip's invasion preparations, Francis Drake led a daring preemptive strike on the Spanish port of Cadiz in April 1587—an event famously known as **"Singeing the King of Spain's beard"**. Drake destroyed roughly 30 Spanish ships and huge supplies of provisions, most notably the seasoned wood needed to make barrels. This raid critically delayed the Armada by a full year, giving England precious time to prepare its defences.

Q3. Causal Linkage: How did the 1587 execution of Mary, Queen of Scots remove Philip II's final diplomatic hesitation to invade England?

In July 1588, Philip's 'Invincible Armada' set sail. The plan was highly complex: the **Duke of Medina Sidonia** would sail 130 ships up the English Channel, anchor off the coast of the Netherlands (at Calais), and meet up with a massive Spanish army led by the **Duke of Parma**. Parma's troops would be ferried across the Channel under the Armada's protection, land in Kent, and march on London.

The plan failed disastrously due to a combination of English brilliance, Spanish incompetence, and the weather:

1. **English Tactics and Technology:** John Hawkins had redesigned the English fleet. English galleons were faster, more manoeuvrable, and had cannons that could be reloaded rapidly. Rather than boarding Spanish ships (Spain's preferred tactic), the English kept their distance and bombarded them. The decisive moment came when the Spanish anchored at Calais. The English launched eight **fireships** into the Spanish fleet at midnight. Panicking, the Spanish captains cut their anchors and scattered, completely breaking their indestructible crescent formation. At the subsequent **Battle of Gravelines**, the English outgunned the chaotic Spanish fleet.
2. **Spanish Mistakes:** Philip appointed the Duke of Medina Sidonia to lead the fleet, despite him having zero naval experience (he even got seasick). Furthermore, communication was terrible. When the Armada arrived at Calais, the Duke of Parma's army simply wasn't ready to board the ships, leaving the Armada sitting ducks for the fireships.
3. **The Weather:** Following the Battle of Gravelines, the wind changed direction, blowing the battered Spanish fleet northwards. With the English blocking the Channel, the Armada was forced to attempt a treacherous journey home around the rocky coasts of Scotland and Ireland. Fierce storms—which the English celebrated as the **"Protestant Wind"**—smashed dozens of Spanish ships against the rocks. Only 65 ships, barely half the fleet, made it back to Spain.

Q4. What fatal logistical assumption sat at the core of Philip II's plan for the Spanish Armada in 1588?

The launch of the Spanish Armada was the inevitable climax of decades of simmering tension. What began as privateering raids in the New World and secret funding of Dutch rebels morphed into a fight for survival. Philip II's plan required perfect timing and communication between his naval fleet and land army—a fatal flaw the English expertly exploited. The defeat of the Armada in 1588 was a monumental triumph for Elizabeth. It did not instantly end the war with Spain, but it provided a massive propaganda victory, 'proving' to the world that God favoured Protestant England, and it secured Elizabeth's legacy as a warrior queen.

Q5. The 'But/Because/So' Strategy: Complete the sentence: Philip II launched the Invincible Armada in 1588, BUT...

Pair & Share Activity

Q6. Discuss with your partner: Why did relations with Spain deteriorate so badly by the 1580s?

L3: KT2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- [ ] Understand the reasons for deteriorating relations with Spain, focusing on religious shifts, the Genoese Loan, the assassination of William of Orange, and the Treaty of Joinville.
- [ ] Analyse the significance of English direct involvement in the Netherlands through the 1585 Treaty of Nonsuch and the actions of Robert Dudley.
- [ ] Evaluate the strategic impact of Francis Drake's preemptive raid on Cadiz in 1587 ('Singeing the King of Spain's beard').

Recall & Retrieval

1. Why was Philip II of Spain angry with Elizabeth?

2. What was a 'privateer'?

3. Which famous English privateer constantly raided Spanish treasure ships?

4. What was the Treaty of Nonsuch (1585)?

5. How much gold did Drake capture from the Spanish ship Cacafuego?

6. Who was Francis Walsingham?

7. What was the Babington Plot (1586)?

8. What was the Revolt of the Northern Earls (1569)?

9. Why was Mary, Queen of Scots a threat?

10. What was the 'Vestment Controversy'?

Vocabulary Check

Conceptual Classification: *Categorise the terms from the word bank into the two historical boxes below:*

Treaty of Nonsuch | Robert Dudley | Spanish Netherlands | Pacification of Ghent | Protestant Rebels | Crescent Formation

Power, Governance & Warfare	Economy, Trade & Society

Source S1: Francis Drake



Sir Francis Drake, an English privateer who raided Spanish ships.

Under Mary Tudor, England and Spain had been staunch Catholic allies. However, Elizabeth's Protestant Religious Settlement fundamentally soured this relationship. Tensions were further *exacerbated* by political and commercial rivalry. In 1568, Elizabeth seized the **Genoese Loan**—gold lent to Spain by Italian bankers that had sheltered in English ports—arguing it belonged to the bankers, not Spain. Furthermore, English privateers relentlessly raided Spanish colonies in the New World. Between 1577 and 1580, Sir Francis Drake alone captured £400,000 of Spanish gold and silver, humiliating Philip II.

Q1. How did events like the 1568 Genoese Loan incident push England and Spain toward open war?

By 1584, the situation in the Netherlands reached a breaking point. The assassination of the Dutch Protestant rebel leader, William of Orange, led Elizabeth to deeply fear that a complete Spanish victory across the Channel was imminent. Her fears were compounded when Spain and Catholic France signed the Treaty of Joinville in 1584, uniting England's two greatest enemies. Feeling she had no other choice, Elizabeth signed the **Treaty of Nonsuch** in August 1585, officially pledging to finance an army of 7,400 English troops to support the Dutch rebels. By sending an army, commanded by Robert Dudley, Earl of Leicester, to directly fight the Spanish, Elizabeth had effectively declared open war. This bold move was a definitive *catalyst for* the Spanish Armada.

Q2. Why did the 1585 Treaty of Nonsuch represent a definitive 'point of no return' in Anglo-Spanish relations?

Dudley's expedition in the Netherlands was, overall, a massive military and political failure because the force was poorly supplied. Immediately upon arriving, Dudley accepted the title of 'Governor General' of the Low Countries, which deeply angered Elizabeth. She still hoped to negotiate with Spain; Dudley, conversely, wanted to completely liberate the Netherlands. This lack of success was severely *exacerbated* when two of Dudley's own officers, **William Stanley** and **Rowland York**, defected to the Spanish side, completely destroying the Dutch rebels' trust in the English. However, Dudley did achieve one highly significant victory. He successfully prevented the Spanish commander, the Duke of Parma, from capturing the deep-water port of **Ostend**. This victory was *intrinsically linked* to the later failure of the Spanish Armada, as Parma was left without a suitable port to safely load his invasion troops onto Spanish ships.

Q3. Why was Robert Dudley's military expedition to the Netherlands between 1585 and 1587 considered an expensive failure?

Furious at English interference, Philip II began assembling a massive invasion fleet. To buy England time, Elizabeth ordered Francis Drake to launch a preemptive strike on the heavily fortified Spanish port of Cadiz in April 1587. Drake sailed right into the harbour, completely destroying roughly 30 Spanish ships and vast amounts of supplies. Crucially, Drake destroyed thousands of seasoned wooden barrel staves. Because of this, the Spanish were later forced to put their food and water into barrels made of new, unseasoned wood, which leaked and caused their provisions to rot long before they reached England. Drake's daring raid—famous as the "singeing of the King of Spain's beard"—successfully delayed the Armada's launch by over a year, giving England crucial time to prepare its coastal defences.

Q4. What was the strategic military significance of Sir Francis Drake's preemptive strike on Cadiz in April 1587?

The period between 1585 and 1588 marked the dramatic transition from cold war to open, state-sponsored conflict. Early provocations like the seizure of the 1568 Genoese Loan and Drake's £400,000 privateering haul severely damaged relations. Ultimately, the Treaty of Nonsuch forced Elizabeth to abandon her preferred strategy of cautious diplomacy. While Robert Dudley's military campaign in the Netherlands was hampered by defection and a lack of royal funding, his protection of the deep-water port of Ostend laid the invisible groundwork for England's future survival. Ultimately, Francis Drake's aggressive, preemptive strike on Cadiz exposed the logistical vulnerabilities of the Spanish Empire and bought Elizabeth the vital time she needed to prepare for the greatest existential threat of her reign: the Spanish Armada.

Q5. Constrained Summary: Outline the three major escalations between 1585 and 1588 that made the Spanish Armada inevitable.

Pair & Share Activity

Q6. Discuss with your partner: Was the outbreak of war with Spain in 1585 inevitable?

L4: KT2.4: The Armada

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- [ ] Understand the complex, overlapping reasons why Philip II finally decided to launch the Spanish Armada in 1588.
- [ ] Analyse the Spanish invasion plans, highlighting the critical logistical flaws from the very beginning.
- [ ] Evaluate the intersecting reasons for the English victory, weighing English tactics against Spanish mistakes and the weather.
- [ ] Explain the immense domestic and international consequences of the Armada's defeat.

Recall & Retrieval

1. What did Drake do in Cadiz in 1587?

2. What phrase did Drake use to describe his attack on Cadiz?

3. When was Mary, Queen of Scots executed?

4. How did Mary's execution affect relations with Spain?

5. What was the Treaty of Nonsuch (1585)?

6. Which English privateer constantly raided Spanish ships?

7. What was the Throckmorton Plot (1583)?

8. Why did Mary, Queen of Scots flee to England?

9. What title did Elizabeth take in the Act of Supremacy?

10. How much debt did Elizabeth inherit in 1558?

Vocabulary Check

Spot the Deliberate Error: *Read the statement below. One historical fact or vocabulary concept has been deliberately falsified. Underline the error and explain the accurate historical reality below:*

Armada | Duke of Medina Sidonia | Galleon | Fireships | Battle of Gravelines | Protestant Wind

> *"In July 1588, the Duke of Medina Sidonia successfully conquered England after Spanish Galleons easily destroyed English Fireships at the Battle of Gravelines."*

Teacher Model / Historical Correction:

Source S1: The Spanish Armada



A painting of the Spanish Armada engaged in battle with the English fleet.

By 1588, the 'Cold War' between England and Spain had reached a boiling point. The personal animosity began decades earlier when Elizabeth rejected Philip II's proposal of marriage. Ultimately, his decision to launch the Armada was driven by three overlapping factors: 1. **Religious Motivation:** Philip II was a fanatical Catholic who believed it was his holy duty to destroy Protestantism. Pope Sixtus V actively encouraged him, turning the invasion into a crusade by promising to forgive the sins of the sailors and offering a massive financial reward of one million gold ducats if they successfully landed. 2. **Political Motivation:** The 1584 Treaty of Joinville united France and Spain, leaving England isolated. Elizabeth's retaliation—signing the 1585 Treaty of Nonsuch to send English troops to the Netherlands—acted as the definitive *catalyst for* war. Furthermore, the execution of the Catholic Mary, Queen of Scots in 1587 meant Philip could no longer rely on assassination plots; he had to conquer England directly to place a Catholic on the throne. 3. **Provocation and Commerce:** Francis Drake's relentless privateering in places like Peru and Mexico had cost Spain hundreds of thousands of pounds in stolen silver. Elizabeth publicly knighting Drake, followed by his humiliating raid on Cadiz in 1587, convinced Philip that English piracy had to be stamped out by force.

Q1. How did the defensive crescent formation used by the Duke of Medina Sidonia in the English Channel reflect Spanish tactical doctrine?

Philip's plan was ambitious but *intrinsically linked* to logistical impossibilities. The Armada, consisting of 130 ships and 30,000 men, was commanded by the Duke of Medina Sidonia, a wealthy nobleman with severe seasickness and zero naval experience. The plan dictated that the Armada would sail in an unbreakable crescent formation up the English Channel. They were to anchor off the coast of the Netherlands at Calais. Here, they would meet the Duke of Parma, who commanded 27,000 battle-hardened Spanish soldiers. The Armada would protect Parma's flat-bottomed barges as they ferried the army across the Channel to land in Kent and march on London. The fatal flaw was communication and deep-water access. Parma did not have a deep-water port, meaning the massive Armada ships could not dock to pick his men up. This logistical nightmare was *exacerbated* by nimble Dutch flyboats blockading Parma's troops in the shallow waters, and the fact that communication by sea took over a week.

Q2. Causal Linkage: How did the absence of a deep-water Flemish port make the Armada's rendezvous with the Duke of Parma impossible?

When the Armada was spotted off the coast of Cornwall on 29 July, warning beacons were lit across England. As the Spanish sailed up the Channel, the English fleet engaged them in skirmishes at Plymouth and the Isle of Wight (3-4 August). The decisive moment occurred when the Armada anchored at Calais, waiting for Parma (who was delayed). At midnight on 7 August 1588, the English sent eight burning fireships drifting into the tightly packed Spanish fleet. Panic erupted. Spanish captains cut their anchors and scattered, entirely destroying their defensive formation. The next day, at the Battle of Gravelines, the English capitalised on the chaos. English cannons were mounted on smaller gun carriages, giving them enough space to recoil and be reloaded rapidly. Conversely, Spanish cannons were designed to fire a single volley before soldiers grappled and boarded enemy ships. The English refused to board, instead staying out of range and firing relentless broadsides, leaving the Spanish utterly defenceless.

Q3. Why was the English deployment of eight fireships at Calais on the night of 7 August 1588 the turning point of the campaign?

Following Gravelines, the wind changed, forcing the battered Armada to flee northwards around the treacherous, uncharted coasts of Scotland and Ireland. Fierce storms smashed over 50 Spanish ships against the rocks, killing roughly 20,000 men. The English celebrated these storms as the "Protestant Wind", claiming God had intervened to protect them. While the fleet was away, Elizabeth visited her

troops at Tilbury, delivering a legendary speech: *"I know I have the body but of a weak and feeble woman; but I have the heart and stomach of a king, and of a king of England too."* The consequences of the victory were monumental. Domestically, it was a massive propaganda triumph. Commemorative medals were struck reading *"God blew, and they were scattered"*, and Elizabeth's legacy was immortalised in the famous Armada Portrait. Internationally, while the war dragged on for another 15 years and Philip II built further armadas, the 1588 victory permanently broke the myth of Spanish invincibility, boosted English naval confidence, and secured England's survival as an independent, Protestant nation.

Q4. What role did Atlantic geography and severe autumn storms play in the destruction of the fleeing Spanish fleet?

The Spanish Armada of 1588 was the ultimate test of Elizabeth's reign. Philip II's motivations were a potent mix of holy crusade, political retaliation for the Netherlands, and fury over privateering. However, his grand strategy required a level of logistical perfection that simply did not exist in the 16th century. The failure of Medina Sidonia and Parma to coordinate at Calais allowed English tactical brilliance (fireships and rapidly reloading long-range broadsides) to break the Spanish lines. Ultimately, however, it was the catastrophic weather—the "Protestant Wind"—that annihilated the fleet. The victory did not end the Anglo-Spanish war, but it delivered an unprecedented propaganda victory that cemented Elizabeth's authority and England's Protestant identity forever.

Q5. Diamond Ranking Challenge: What was the decisive reason for the Armada's defeat: (A) English naval tactics and ship design, (B) Spanish logistical and leadership errors, or (C) The adverse weather? Justify your argument.

Pair & Share Activity

Q6. Discuss with your partner: Why did the Spanish Armada fail?